

Shrimp Feed Management - Standard Operating Procedure

Bayshore Sustainable Aquaculture | *L. vannamei* grow-out | SOP F-2

Feeding drives both growth and water quality. Overfeeding fouls the biofilter and spikes ammonia; underfeeding costs growth and uniformity. This SOP sets the daily method for the grow-out hall.

Daily method

- 1 Read water quality before first feed. If dissolved oxygen is below 5.0 mg/L or ammonia is climbing, cut the next ration and address the cause first.
- 2 Feed to the tray, not the clock. Check feed trays 90 minutes after feeding; clean trays mean feed more, leftover means feed less.
- 3 Split the daily ration across four feeds during peak grow-out; three feeds in the early stage.
- 4 Weigh feed; do not scoop by eye. Record grams per tank on the feed sheet.

Ration guide by mean weight

Mean weight	Percent body weight / day	Feeds / day
1 - 3 g	8 - 6 %	3
3 - 8 g	6 - 4 %	3-4
8 - 15 g	4 - 3 %	4
15 g - harvest	3 - 2 %	4

Rules of thumb

- Warm afternoons: pull the mid-day feed back; oxygen demand peaks with temperature.
- Day before a partial harvest or grading: reduce the evening feed to keep guts clear.
- Store feed dry and sealed; rotate first-in first-out; never feed clumped or musty feed.
- Target feed conversion at or under 1.6 to 1; track it every cycle.

Operating procedure. Feed-sheet figures feed the cycle FCR and the cost-per-pound calculation.